



PHOENIX VAPERS
LIMITED

BRAND IDENTITY SYSTEM
VOLUME ONE · MMXXVI

THE OFFICIAL BRAND IDENTITY BOOK

The Standard of Trust.

*A complete brand identity system for the United Kingdom's
most rigorously engineered vaping company.*

PHOENIX VAPERS LIMITED
PETERBOROUGH · UNITED KINGDOM
ESTABLISHED RETAILER & MANUFACTURER

STRATEGY · VERBAL · VISUAL · APPLICATION
CONFIDENTIAL — INTERNAL & PARTNER USE
EDITION 1.0

COLOPHON

This document is the definitive articulation of the Phoenix Vapers brand: the reasoning behind it, the system that expresses it, and the standards that protect it.

It has been prepared as an enterprise-grade reference for every party who shapes how Phoenix Vapers is seen, read, and experienced — the leadership team, in-house designers and marketers, packaging and print partners, retail and exhibition contractors, digital product teams, and external agencies. It is intended to remain the governing reference for the brand across the coming decade, revised only through the formal process described in the closing part of this book.

Every recommendation in these pages is derived from a single source of truth: the strategy established in the Phoenix Vapers Product Requirements Document, read against the realities of the United Kingdom vaping market as it stands following the Tobacco and Vapes Act 2026. Nothing here is decoration for its own sake. Each decision — a colour value, a measure of clear space, a turn of phrase — is made to advance a commercial position: that Phoenix Vapers is the most trusted, most rigorously engineered, most responsibly operated vaping company in Britain.

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PART ONE

Strategy & Market

- 01 Executive Summary
- 02 About Phoenix Vapers
- 03 The Industry & the UK Market
- 04 Consumer Behaviour
- 05 Competitive Landscape & SWOT

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Executive Summary

Phoenix Vapers is not entering a growth market. It is inheriting a corrected one — a market in which trust, compliance, and engineering discipline have become the only durable sources of advantage. This book builds the brand for that reality.

For a decade the British vaping industry rewarded speed over substance. Brightly coloured disposable devices, sweet packaging, and disposable-income pricing built enormous volume and almost no loyalty. That era is over. On 1 June 2025 the sale of single-use disposable vapes became illegal across all four nations of the United Kingdom. On 29 April 2026 the Tobacco and Vapes Act received Royal Assent, bringing an advertising ban, a retail licensing regime, and enforceable point-of-sale powers. From 1 October 2026 a Vaping Products Duty of £2.20 per ten millilitres applies to every e-liquid sold, nicotine-bearing or not. The market has been forcibly matured. What remains is a category that must now compete on the things Phoenix Vapers has quietly done well for years.

This is the strategic opening the brand has been waiting for. Phoenix Vapers already manufactures in the United Kingdom, analyses its e-liquids through professional chemists, holds ISO 9001 certification for its quality management, and has every product independently risk-assessed by EL-Science. In the old market these were invisible virtues. In the new market they are precisely what a licensed, tax-registered, advertising-restricted trade demands. The task of this brand system is not to invent a story. It is to make the truth of the business legible, premium, and impossible to confuse with the disposable culture the country has just rejected.

The strategic position in one sentence

Phoenix Vapers is positioned as **the standard of trust in British vaping**: an engineering-led, compliance-first manufacturer and retailer that treats a regulated nicotine product with the seriousness it deserves. Every subsequent decision in this book — the retention and disciplining of the green, the adoption of a neutral grotesque and a technical mono, the restraint of the packaging, the sobriety of the voice — exists to make that single position felt before it is read.

2025

Disposable vapes banned across the UK — the market resets toward refillable and pod systems

£2.20

Vaping Products Duty per 10ml from October 2026, applied to every e-liquid

ISO 9001

Certified quality management — a credential the new market makes central, not peripheral

What this book delivers

The publication is organised as a single argument in six parts. Part One establishes the market and the audience. Part Two defines the brand idea — its position, purpose, personality, and story. Part Three governs the language. Part Four specifies the complete visual system, built around

the existing brand green. Part Five applies that system across packaging, retail, digital, and fleet. Part Six sets out how the brand is protected, measured, and allowed to evolve.

Read in sequence, it moves from why the brand exists to how every touchpoint should look, read, and behave. Read as reference, any chapter can be consulted in isolation by a partner producing a single artefact. Both readings are intended, and both are governed by the same principle stated throughout: restraint is not the absence of design. For a company asking the public to trust it with a regulated product, restraint *is* the design.

THE THROUGH-LINE

A disposable brand sells a moment. Phoenix Vapers sells a standard. Everything in this book is built to make a standard visible — and to make it feel like relief in a category that has spent a decade shouting.

About Phoenix Vapers

A Peterborough manufacturer and retailer with a rare combination of assets: it makes what it sells, tests what it makes, and operates across the full chain from formulation to shelf.

Phoenix Vapers Limited operates from Peterborough as a vertically engaged business rather than a reseller. It formulates and produces e-liquids in the United Kingdom, retails through its own e-commerce platform and physical stores, supplies the trade at wholesale, and maintains its own hardware, coil, and accessory ranges alongside proprietary e-liquid lines. This breadth is unusual. Most vaping businesses occupy a single link in the chain — they either make liquid, or import hardware, or run shops. Phoenix Vapers spans formulation, quality assurance, retail, and distribution, and that span is the material foundation on which the brand is built.

The four operating identities

The organisation should be understood as four businesses sharing one standard. As a **manufacturer**, it develops e-liquid recipes and produces them under controlled conditions, with proprietary lines that give it identity and margin independent of third-party brands. As a **retailer**, it sells directly to the adult consumer through a website and a store network, owning the relationship rather than renting it. As a **wholesaler**, it supplies other retailers, extending the standard beyond its own shelves. And as an emerging **technology platform**, it holds the data, logistics, and compliance infrastructure that the licensed future of the category will require. The brand must be legible across all four without fragmenting.

The evidence already in the business

Three assets deserve particular emphasis because they will carry disproportionate strategic weight in the chapters that follow. The first is **UK manufacture with in-house chemical analysis**: products are produced domestically and examined by professional chemists rather than accepted on a supplier's word. The second is **ISO 9001 certification**, an internationally recognised standard for quality management that signals systematic process control rather than ad hoc effort. The third is **independent risk assessment through EL-Science**, a specialist that has invested substantially in product safety science and whose consumer-facing assessments Phoenix Vapers makes available in its stores.

WHY THIS MATTERS NOW

In a licensed, tax-registered market with mandatory product registration, these credentials stop being reassurances and start being requirements. Phoenix Vapers already meets a bar the rest of the market is being forced to reach. The brand's job is to make that head-start unmistakable.

The business has outgrown its current expression. The existing identity communicates a competent independent retailer; it does not communicate a compliance-first manufacturer with a decade of quality infrastructure and a claim on the premium centre of the market. The mandate of this book is to close that gap — to give a serious business a serious identity, without discarding the equity already held in the Phoenix name and the established brand green. This is a disciplining of the brand, not a replacement of it.

HEADQUARTERS	MODEL	QUALITY
Peterborough, UK	Make · Test · Retail · Supply	ISO 9001 · EL-Science

The Industry & the UK Market

The United Kingdom has, in eighteen months, rewritten the rules of vaping more comprehensively than in the previous decade. Understanding that new rulebook is the precondition for every brand decision that follows.

Vaping in Britain sits at an unusual intersection. It is simultaneously a public-health instrument — the country's most effective smoking-cessation aid — and a consumer category under intensifying regulatory constraint. The brand cannot pretend the second reality away, nor should it. The companies that will lead the licensed era are those that treat regulation not as a burden to be survived but as the terrain on which trust is won. Phoenix Vapers is built to lead precisely there.

The three settled facts

Three regulatory realities now define the market and are unlikely to reverse. First, the **disposable ban**: since 1 June 2025 it has been illegal to sell single-use vapes anywhere in the UK, a measure driven by environmental waste — millions of devices discarded weekly — and by youth-access concern. The category has migrated to refillable and prefilled pod systems, exactly the responsible, reusable formats Phoenix Vapers already prioritises. Second, the **Tobacco and Vapes Act 2026**, which received Royal Assent on 29 April 2026, introducing a vaping advertising and sponsorship ban, a retail licensing scheme, mandatory product registration, point-of-sale display powers, and on-the-spot fines for underage sales. Third, the **Vaping Products Duty**: from 1 October 2026, £2.20 per ten millilitres applies to all e-liquid regardless of nicotine content, with registration having opened in April 2026.

REGULATORY INSTRUMENT	STATUS	STRATEGIC CONSEQUENCE FOR THE BRAND
Disposable vape ban	In force since 1 Jun 2025	Reusable, refillable formats become the norm; responsibility is now table stakes
TPD / TRPR 2016	In force	20mg/ml nicotine cap, 2ml tank limit, 10ml bottle limit, MHRA notification
Tobacco & Vapes Act 2026	Royal Assent 29 Apr 2026	Advertising ban; retail licensing; brand equity must be earned at point of sale, not bought
Vaping Products Duty	From 1 Oct 2026	£2.20 / 10ml on all e-liquid; price competition erodes, quality competition rises
Age of sale · Challenge 25	In force	18+ only; verification rigour becomes a visible brand behaviour

What the advertising ban does to branding

The forthcoming prohibition on vaping advertising and sponsorship is the single most consequential fact for this document. When a category can no longer buy attention, the brand itself — the packaging on the shelf, the fascia of the shop, the experience of the website, the tone of a customer email — becomes the entire marketing surface. There is no campaign to compensate for a weak identity. The identity *is* the campaign. This is why the investment represented by this book is not cosmetic: in an advertising-restricted market, the brand system is the primary commercial asset the company owns.

DESIGN IMPLICATION

Every pound previously available to shout must now be earned through restraint. The most valuable square centimetres Phoenix Vapers owns are the label, the fascia, and the interface. This book treats each as prime media.

The duty and the flight to quality

The Vaping Products Duty compresses the market's historic advantage — cheapness — and rewards its historic weakness — quality. When every ten millilitres carries the same £2.20 charge, the relative premium of a well-made, well-tested, well-packaged product shrinks. A consumer paying duty on everything has less reason to accept an inferior product to save a few pence. This is a structural tailwind for a manufacturer whose entire proposition is that its liquids are made properly and tested independently. The brand should never mention tax; it should simply be the obvious choice once tax has flattened the field.

Consumer Behaviour

The adult vaper of 2026 is not the impulse buyer of 2021. They are more informed, more sceptical, more cost-aware, and – after a decade of hype – quietly exhausted by the category's noise.

The disposable era trained a generation of consumers to treat vaping as fast-moving and disposable in every sense: cheap to buy, easy to abandon, loyal to nothing. The correction has produced a different customer. Forced onto refillable and pod systems, they must now make considered choices about hardware, coils, and liquid. They must understand nicotine strength, PG/VG ratio, and flavour longevity. They are, in short, becoming users rather than consumers — and users reward competence.

The four behavioural shifts

Four movements in consumer psychology shape how the brand must behave. Each is an opportunity for a company built on substance.

Shift 01

From impulse to consideration

Reusable devices demand a purchase decision, not a grab. Consumers research, compare, and expect information. The brand must reward that scrutiny with clarity rather than persuasion.

Shift 02

From novelty to reliability

Having been let down by devices that failed and flavours that faded, the market now prizes consistency. Reliability, not surprise, is the emotional need to be met.

Shift 03

From price to value

With duty flattening headline price, value shifts to performance, safety, and longevity. The question moves from "what is cheapest" to "what is worth it".

Shift 04

From scepticism to trust-seeking

Amid health anxiety and illicit-market fear, consumers actively seek signals of legitimacy: UK manufacture, testing, registration, transparency. They are looking for permission to relax.

The emotional job to be done

Beneath the functional needs sits an emotional one that the entire brand is designed to serve: **the desire to feel responsible about a habit the world disapproves of**. The adult vaper is frequently a former smoker who has made a genuine improvement to their life and is tired of being treated as either a child or a delinquent. They want a product, and a company, that treats them as an

intelligent adult making a considered choice. Phoenix Vapers' restraint, sobriety, and transparency are not stylistic preferences. They are the direct expression of respect for that customer — and respect, in this category, is a competitive act.

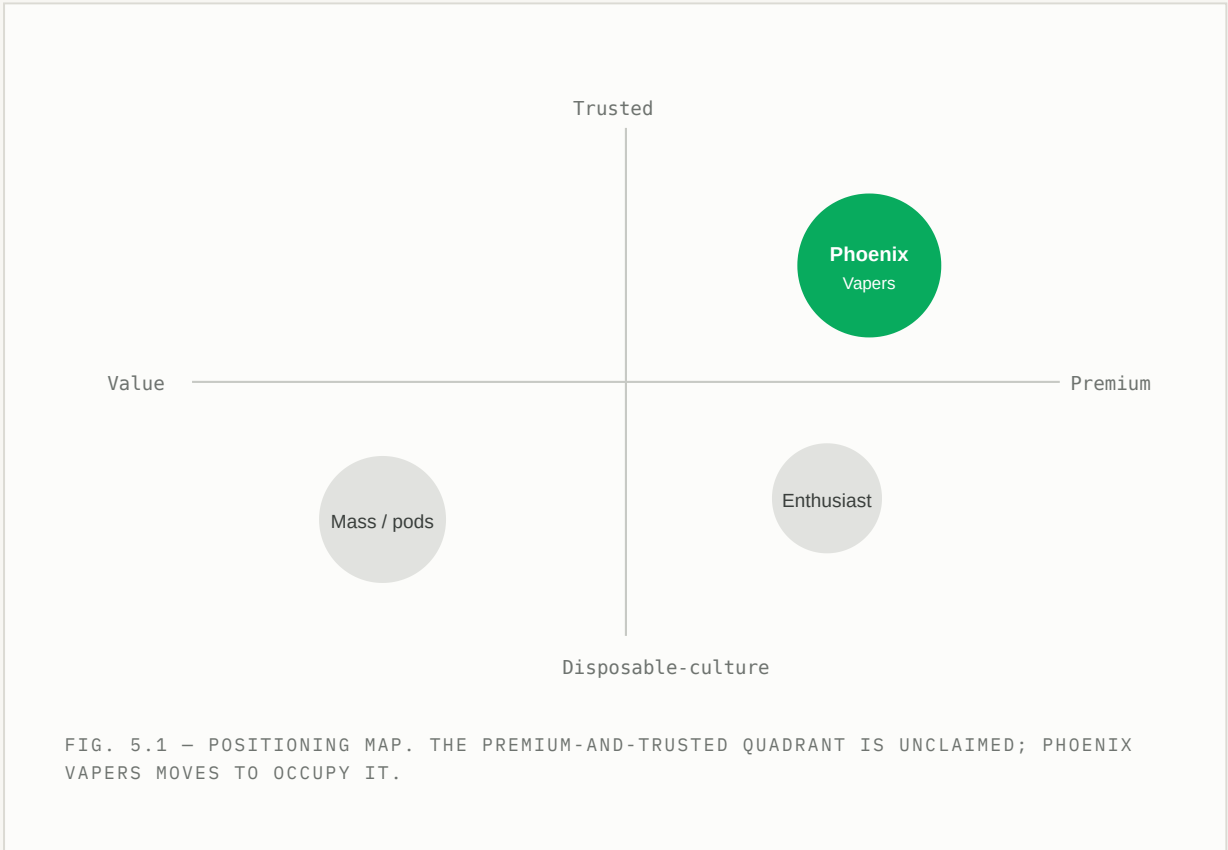
BEHAVIOURAL INSIGHT

The category has spent a decade making adults feel like teenagers. The opportunity is to make them feel like adults again. Every quiet, precise, well-made touchpoint is a small act of respect — and respect is what earns the switch.

Competitive Landscape & SWOT

The competition is not other vape shops. It is the visual and behavioural clutter of the entire category – and the empty premium centre that no British vaping brand has yet credibly claimed.

The UK vaping market is crowded at two poles and vacant in the middle. At one pole sit the mass brands and disposable-descended pod systems — high volume, loud packaging, price-led, now scrambling to look responsible. At the other pole sit hobbyist and sub-ohm specialists — technical, enthusiast-facing, visually chaotic, speaking to a narrow expert audience. Between them lies the position no one occupies with conviction: the **premium, trustworthy, adult mainstream** — the vaper who wants neither a toy nor a rig, but a well-made product from a company that behaves like a grown-up.



SWOT analysis

Strengths

UK manufacture with in-house chemical analysis. ISO 9001 certification. Independent EL-Science risk assessment. Vertical span across make, test, retail, and supply. Proprietary e-liquid lines. Established Phoenix name and brand green.

Weaknesses

Current identity under-communicates the quality behind it. Regional recognition rather than national. Digital experience not yet at premium standard. Proprietary lines carry playful naming inconsistent with a premium centre.

Opportunities

The advertising ban makes brand the whole game. Duty flattens price advantage and rewards quality. The premium-trusted quadrant is empty. Licensing favours credentialled incumbents. Wholesale can export the standard.

Threats

Illicit and non-compliant supply undercutting on price. Larger nationals repositioning toward responsibility. Further flavour and packaging restrictions via secondary legislation. Public-health sentiment hardening against the category.

STRATEGIC CONCLUSION

Phoenix Vapers' strengths map almost exactly onto the market's new demands, and its weaknesses are largely matters of expression rather than substance. This is the ideal condition for a rebrand: the business is already what the market needs; the brand simply has not yet said so.

PART TWO

The Brand Idea

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 - 10 Values & Principles
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 - 12 Audience & Personas

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Positioning

Positioning is the single most important decision a brand makes, because it determines every decision after it. Phoenix Vapers takes the one position the market has left open and that the business is uniquely equipped to defend.

A position is not a slogan or a look. It is the specific place a brand occupies in the mind of a customer relative to every alternative — the answer to the question "why this one?" that forms before the customer is consciously aware of asking it. A strong position is true, distinctive, and defensible. It must be honest to the business, different from competitors, and difficult to copy. Phoenix Vapers has all three available to it, provided it has the discipline to choose narrowly and hold the line.

The positioning statement

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For the adult who has chosen to vape and refuses to be careless about it, Phoenix Vapers is the British vaping company that engineers trust into every product — because it makes what it sells, tests what it makes, and treats a regulated product with the seriousness it deserves.

Read the statement closely, because each clause is load-bearing. **"For the adult who has chosen to vape and refuses to be careless about it"** defines the audience by attitude rather than demographic — the considered vaper, not the impulse buyer. **"The British vaping company that engineers trust"** claims the category benefit — trust — and attributes it to a method — engineering — rather than to assertion. **"Makes what it sells, tests what it makes"** supplies the proof. **"Treats a regulated product with the seriousness it deserves"** converts the constraint of regulation into a signal of respect. The statement is defensible because a competitor cannot claim it without also building the manufacturing, testing, and compliance infrastructure that stands behind it.

The four pillars of the position

Pillar 01

Engineering-led

The brand frames itself through the language and discipline of engineering — precision, tolerance, testing, specification — not lifestyle or indulgence.

Pillar 02

Compliance-first

Regulation is treated as a floor to exceed, not a ceiling to reach. Compliance is made visible as a virtue, never hidden as a cost.

Pillar 03

British-made

Domestic manufacture and analysis anchor provenance, accountability, and quality in a market anxious about illicit imports.

Pillar 04

Quietly premium

Premium is expressed through restraint and material quality, not ornament — the confidence of a brand that does not need to shout.

THE DISCIPLINE THIS DEMANDS

A position is defended by what a brand refuses to do. Phoenix Vapers will decline the loud packaging, the discount-led messaging, the youth-adjacent aesthetics, and the novelty-chasing that define the category. Saying no to these is not caution. It is the strategy.

Purpose, Vision & Mission

Three statements, three time horizons. Purpose is why the company exists at all. Vision is the future it is working toward. Mission is what it does every day to get there.

These three are frequently confused and often reduced to interchangeable marketing lines. They are not interchangeable. Together they form a hierarchy of intent that should cascade into every plan, every hire, and every design decision. Stated well, they are internal instruments before they are external claims — the compass the organisation steers by, not the flag it waves.

PURPOSE • WHY WE EXIST

To bring integrity to a category that has too often lacked it — so that choosing to vape need never mean choosing carelessly.

The purpose reaches beyond commerce without abandoning it. It acknowledges the category's real failings and positions Phoenix Vapers as the corrective. It is deliberately durable: it will remain true whether the company sells liquids, hardware, or the technology platforms of a licensed future.

VISION • WHERE WE ARE GOING

To be recognised as the most trusted vaping company in the United Kingdom — the standard against which the responsible market measures itself.

The vision is a destination, not a description. "Most trusted" is a measurable ambition — in prompted and unprompted brand trust, in retention, in wholesale advocacy. "The standard against which the market measures itself" sets the bar higher still: not merely to be trusted, but to define what trustworthiness in the category looks like.

MISSION • WHAT WE DO DAILY

To engineer, test, and supply vaping products of uncompromising quality, and to make the evidence of that quality plain to everyone we serve.

The mission is operational and testable. It commits the company not only to quality but to the *transparency* of quality — the second clause is what distinguishes Phoenix Vapers from any competitor content to be good in private. Making the evidence plain is a design brief as much as an operational one, and it recurs throughout the visual and verbal systems that follow.

PURPOSE

Why



VISION

Where



MISSION

What



ENDURING ————— IMMEDIATE

FIG. 7.1 – THE INTENT HIERARCHY FROM ENDURING PURPOSE TO DAILY MISSION.

Promise & Value Proposition

A promise is what the customer can rely on every time. A value proposition is the specific, comparative reason to choose Phoenix Vapers over the alternative in front of them.

The brand promise

BRAND PROMISE

Nothing reaches you that we have not made properly and checked ourselves.

A promise must be simple enough to remember, specific enough to be broken, and important enough to matter. This one qualifies on all three counts. It is the emotional distillation of the manufacturing and testing infrastructure — expressed not as a boast about the company but as a reassurance to the customer. It is written in the first person plural because a promise is made by people, not by a corporation. And it is falsifiable, which is what makes it credible: a promise that cannot be broken cannot be trusted.

The value proposition

Where the promise is emotional, the value proposition is rational and comparative. It answers the question a customer asks with a competitor's product already in their hand.

DIMENSION	THE CATEGORY DEFAULT	THE PHOENIX VAPERS ALTERNATIVE
Origin	Imported, opaque supply chains	Made and analysed in the United Kingdom
Testing	Supplier assurances, minimal verification	In-house chemists; independent EL-Science risk assessment
Quality system	Ad hoc, uncertified	ISO 9001 certified management
Transparency	Claims without evidence	Risk assessments made available to the customer
Design	Loud, disposable-culture aesthetics	Restrained, premium, adult

REASONS TO BELIEVE

A proposition is only as strong as its evidence. Phoenix Vapers' reasons to believe — UK manufacture, in-house analysis, ISO 9001, EL-Science assessment — are not marketing claims to be invented. They already exist. The brand's task is disclosure, not persuasion.

Brand DNA, Personality & Archetype

If the brand were a person, who would it be? The answer governs how it speaks, what it wears, and how it makes people feel — and it must be consistent across every encounter.

Brands are understood by people the way people are understood by people: through a small number of consistent traits inferred from behaviour. A brand with a clear, stable personality is easier to trust because it is predictable, and predictability is the foundation of trust. The following model defines Phoenix Vapers' character so precisely that a copywriter, a designer, and a customer-service agent who have never met will nonetheless produce work that feels like the same company.

Brand DNA

At the core sit four traits that cannot be compromised without changing what the brand fundamentally is: **Precise, Responsible, Understated, Assured**. These are the genetic markers. Every expression of the brand should be testable against them — if a piece of work is imprecise, careless, loud, or anxious, it is off-brand regardless of how attractive it may be.

The archetype

Drawing on the archetypal framework that underpins much of modern brand theory, Phoenix Vapers is primarily **The Sage**, with a supporting register of **The Creator**. The Sage seeks truth, values expertise, and earns influence through knowledge and honesty rather than charm or dominance. It is the archetype of the trusted expert — the pharmacist, the engineer, the analyst — and it is exactly right for a company whose entire proposition is competence you can rely on. The Creator support brings the engineering pride: the satisfaction of making something properly, to specification, without shortcuts.

Primary · The Sage

Truth over persuasion

Influence earned through knowledge and transparency. Speaks plainly, cites evidence, respects the customer's intelligence, never manipulates.

Support · The Creator

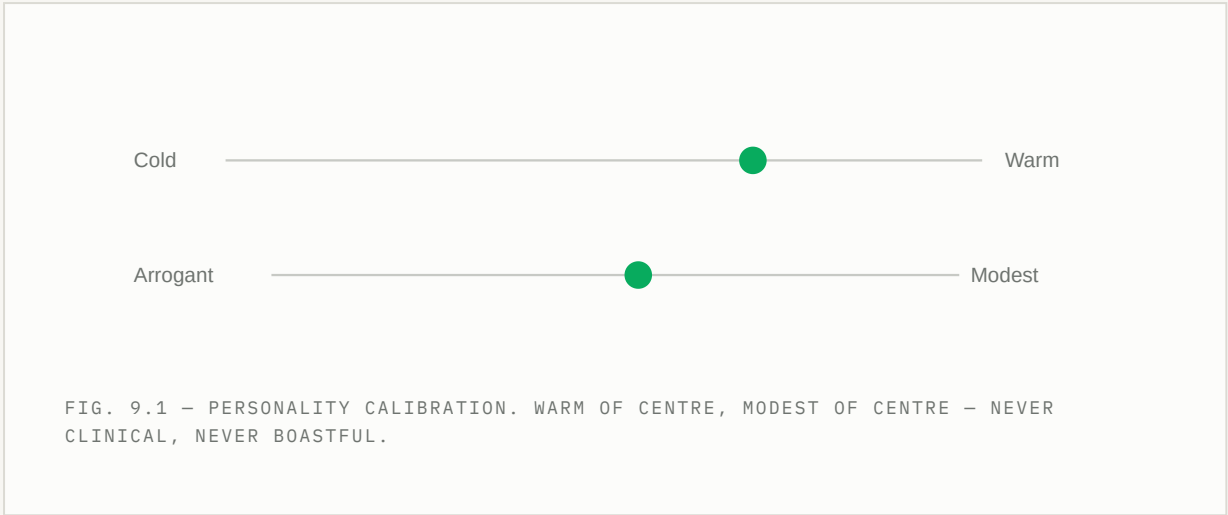
Made properly

Pride in craft and specification. The quiet satisfaction of a thing engineered correctly, tested thoroughly, and finished with care.

Personality expressed as tension

A personality without tension is bland. Phoenix Vapers holds two productive tensions that keep it human. It is **authoritative but not cold** — expert without being clinical, because trust requires warmth as well as competence. And it is **confident but not arrogant** — sure of its standards

without disparaging the customer's past choices. Managing these tensions is the ongoing craft of the brand, and it is why the tone-of-voice chapter that follows matters as much as any visual specification.



Values & Principles

Values describe what the company believes. Principles translate those beliefs into rules that can settle a real decision when two good options compete.

Most stated values are useless because they are unfalsifiable — no company claims to value dishonesty or carelessness. A value earns its place only if it can be violated and if it can adjudicate a hard choice. The five below are written to do exactly that: each implies a sacrifice the company is willing to make, which is what gives it force.

Value 01

Rigour

We would rather be slow and correct than quick and wrong. Testing is not negotiable, even when it costs time or margin.

Value 02

Transparency

We show the evidence, including what is uncertain. We would rather lose a sale than mislead a customer.

Value 03

Restraint

We say and show less. We would rather be underestimated at a glance than misunderstood on inspection.

Value 04

Responsibility

We treat a regulated product responsibly, and we would decline growth that compromises that.

Value 05

Craft

We finish things properly. We would rather ship later than ship something we are not proud of.

Operating principles

Where values are beliefs, principles are decision rules. They are written as imperatives so that anyone in the organisation — or any partner producing work under the brand — can apply them without escalation.

- When restraint and expression compete, choose restraint.
- When a claim is available but not yet proven, do not make it.
- When clarity and cleverness compete, choose clarity.
- When the loud option and the quiet option perform equally, choose the quiet one.
- When a design decision cannot be justified against the strategy, remove it.

- When in doubt about tone, imagine explaining the product to an intelligent adult who is sceptical of the category.
-

Brand Story & Narrative

A brand story is not history. It is the meaningful shape given to history — the reason the company's past explains why it is the right choice now.

The Phoenix is one of the oldest symbols in human culture, and it has been trivialised by the vaping category into a shorthand for fire and smoke. This book reclaims it for its true meaning, which has nothing to do with flame. The Phoenix is the emblem of renewal through discipline — of something better rising from what came before, deliberately and by design. That is the brand's story, and it maps precisely onto both the company and its market.

The narrative in three movements

What came before. A category that grew too fast on products made too carelessly, that treated adults like children and the environment like an afterthought, and that has now been corrected by regulation and by its own excesses. The disposable era is the ash.

The renewal. From that correction rises a different kind of vaping company — one that makes rather than merely sells, tests rather than assumes, and treats the customer as an adult. Not a rejection of vaping, but its maturation. The Phoenix does not escape the fire; it is defined by what it becomes after it.

The standard set. Phoenix Vapers does not simply participate in the renewed market. It sets the standard for it — the reference point the responsible industry measures itself against. The story ends not with survival but with leadership.

NARRATIVE DISCIPLINE

The Phoenix is expressed as ascent, renewal, and rigour — never as literal fire, smoke, or flame. This is a firm rule of the visual system that follows. The symbol earns its gravity precisely by refusing the cliché the category expects of it.

The elevator narrative

Compressed to a single spoken paragraph, for use by anyone representing the company:

"Phoenix Vapers is a British vaping company built on a simple idea — that a regulated product deserves to be made properly and checked honestly. We manufacture and test our liquids in the UK, we hold our quality to certified standards, and we have every product independently risk-assessed. In a market that spent a decade cutting corners, we are the company that didn't. That is the whole business, and it is the whole brand."

Audience & Personas

The brand is not for everyone who vapes – and its clarity depends on knowing precisely who it is for, and who it is willing to let go.

Phoenix Vapers segments its audience by attitude rather than age, because attitude predicts behaviour and loyalty far better than demographics in this category. Three primary segments are served by the retail brand, and a fourth by the wholesale operation. Each persona below is a composite, written to make an abstract segment concrete enough to design for. All are, without exception, adults of legal age; the brand serves no one under eighteen, and its every behaviour reinforces that boundary.

Persona A

The Considered Switcher

Late 30s, former smoker of fifteen years. Vapes to stay off cigarettes and takes it seriously. Reads ingredients, distrusts cheap imports, wants reassurance more than novelty. Buys on trust and stays for consistency. The core customer.

Persona B

The Quality Seeker

Late 20s, established vaper. Has moved past disposables to refillable systems and now cares about flavour fidelity, device reliability, and brand credibility. Will pay a premium for something demonstrably better made. Values design.

Persona C

The Cautious Beginner

40s, newly switching. Anxious about doing it wrong, intimidated by jargon and enthusiast culture. Needs guidance, plain language, and a sense of safety. Rewards the brand that treats them as capable rather than clueless.

Persona D

The Trade Partner

Independent retailer or reseller. Under licensing and compliance pressure, needs a supplier whose credentials protect them. Buys the standard as much as the stock. Served by the wholesale brand.

Who the brand is not for

Clarity requires exclusion. Phoenix Vapers is not for the price-only buyer who will always chase the cheapest option regardless of provenance; not for the trick-cloud enthusiast for whom vaping is a hobby of spectacle; and, categorically, not for anyone under the age of eighteen. Designing away from these groups is not a loss of market. It is the discipline that makes the brand legible to the market it wants.

Every persona the brand serves shares one thing: they want to feel like a responsible adult making a considered choice. That single insight — not a demographic — is the true target of every design and word in this book.

PART THREE

Verbal Identity

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- 14 Copywriting & Naming
- 15 Compliance & Legal Language

Tone of Voice

In an advertising-restricted market, words on a label, a screen, and an email are among the few marketing surfaces the company still fully controls. How Phoenix Vapers writes is therefore not a detail. It is the brand made audible.

Voice is the consistent personality behind everything the company writes; tone is how that voice adapts to context. Phoenix Vapers has one voice — that of the Sage: knowledgeable, plain-spoken, calm, and respectful — and it modulates in tone from the reassurance of a product description to the precision of a compliance notice. The reader should never be able to mistake a Phoenix Vapers sentence for a competitor's, and they should never feel spoken down to, hyped up, or sold at.

Four voice principles

Voice 01

Plain before clever

Say the true thing simply. Clarity is a form of respect; cleverness that obscures is a failure. If a plainer word exists, use it.

Voice 02

Evidence, not adjectives

Prefer a fact to a superlative. "Analysed by our chemists" outperforms "amazing quality" because it can be checked. Show; do not exclaim.

Voice 03

Calm authority

Never anxious, never breathless, never urgent. The brand does not chase. Confidence reads as an even, unhurried register.

Voice 04

Adult to adult

Address the reader as a capable equal. No infantilising, no scolding, no innuendo. Assume intelligence and reward it.

The voice in practice

CONTEXT	OFF - BRAND	ON - BRAND
Product intro	"Get ready for an EXPLOSION of flavour!! 🔥"	"A clean, balanced strawberry. Made and tested in our UK lab."
Reassurance	"Trust us, it's totally safe."	"Every batch is risk-assessed independently. You can read the assessment in store."
Out of stock	"Oops! Sold out, soz!"	"Currently unavailable. We restock rather than substitute — it will return."
Delivery	"Your goodies are on the way!"	"Your order has left our facility. Tracking is below."

THE ONE-LINE TEST

Before anything is published, read it aloud and ask: does this sound like a competent adult explaining something they know well to an adult they respect? If not, rewrite it until it does.

Words the brand uses — and avoids

Use

analysed · tested · engineered · specification · batch · formulated · verified · standard · precise · responsible · in-house · assessed · consistent

Avoid

explosion · insane · killer · cloud-chasing · unbeatable · cheapest · amazing · vibes · legendary · game-changing · exclusive drop · fire · smoke

Copywriting & Naming

The rules that turn a voice into finished copy – and a naming architecture that lets a premium parent brand carry playful product lines without contradiction.

Copywriting mechanics

Consistency in the small mechanics is what makes a brand feel engineered rather than improvised. Phoenix Vapers writes in British English without exception — *colour, flavour, analyse, licence, centre, organisation*. Sentences are short and declarative. The active voice is preferred. Numerals are used for specifications and quantities. Exclamation marks are effectively banned outside genuine exception. Full stops are welcome; the brand is comfortable with the authority of a short, finished sentence.

- Lead with the fact, not the feeling. The feeling follows from the fact.
- One idea per sentence. One purpose per paragraph.
- Specify. "60/40 VG/PG" tells the reader more than "smooth and satisfying".
- Never promise what testing has not confirmed.
- Cut every word that does not carry meaning. Then cut one more.

The naming architecture

The company already operates proprietary e-liquid lines with expressive names such as its bar-salt and fifty-fifty ranges. A premium parent brand need not sterilise these — but it must frame them. The solution is a disciplined hierarchy in which the Phoenix Vapers masterbrand supplies the credibility and the product lines supply the character, each clearly subordinate and consistently locked-up to the parent.

TIER	ROLE	NAMING CHARACTER	EXAMPLE
Masterbrand	Guarantor of trust	Formal, singular, unchanging	Phoenix Vapers
Ranges	Product families	Descriptive, restrained	Phoenix Salts · Phoenix Shortfill
Lines	Character-led sub-brands	Expressive, but locked to parent	Bar Wars · FiftyFifty
Variants	Individual flavours	Plain, appetising, honest	Cherry Cola · Strawberry Ice

Expressive lines are always endorsed by the masterbrand — "Bar Wars, by Phoenix Vapers" — never left to stand alone. The character sells the flavour; the parent sells the trust. Neither is asked to do the other's job.

Naming a new flavour

Flavour names describe the flavour. They do not borrow from confectionery brands, cartoon characters, or anything that could read as directed at children — a discipline that also anticipates the packaging and flavour-description powers granted by the Tobacco and Vapes Act. Honest, appetising, adult: *Cedar, Blackcurrant, Menthol, Cherry Cola*. The name earns appetite through accuracy, not through hype.

Compliance & Legal Language

For most brands, legal copy is where personality goes to die. For Phoenix Vapers, it is where the brand's core promise is proven — so it is designed with the same care as everything else.

Regulatory and legal text — age verification, nicotine warnings, ingredient disclosures, terms, delivery restrictions — is not a compliance tax the brand endures. It is the most literal expression of the brand's central claim to responsibility. Handled with clarity and dignity, it becomes evidence rather than fine print. Phoenix Vapers writes its mandatory copy to be read, not hidden.

Principles for regulated copy

Legal 01

Clear, not buried

Required warnings are set legibly, never shrunk to the legal minimum in the hope no one reads them. Visibility signals confidence.

Legal 02

Plain-language first

Where the law permits, explain the requirement in human terms alongside the formal wording. The reader should understand, not merely be notified.

Legal 03

Firm on age

Age restriction is stated plainly and enforced visibly. Challenge 25 and 18+ verification are presented as care, never as obstacle.

Legal 04

Never defensive

Compliance copy is calm and matter-of-fact. The brand is not apologising for the rules; it is demonstrably ahead of them.

Standing statements

The following are approved standing forms. They may be shortened for space but not softened in meaning.

AGE VERIFICATION

"You must be 18 or over to purchase from Phoenix Vapers. We verify age at checkout and on delivery. If you look under 25, expect to be asked for identification — we would rather ask twice than sell once to someone underage."

PRODUCT ASSURANCE

"This product is manufactured in the United Kingdom, notified to the MHRA, and independently risk-assessed. The assessment is available on request and in our stores."

CONTAINS NICOTINE

Where a nicotine warning is mandated, it is rendered in the system's neutral grotesque, at full legibility, in graphite on light or bone on dark — never disguised, never decorative. The warning is part of the design, not an intrusion upon it.

PART FOUR

Visual Identity

16 Logo Philosophy & Construction

17 Clear Space, Sizing & Misuse

18 The Colour System

19 Colour Accessibility

20 Typography

21 Grid, Layout & Iconography

22 Photography & Graphic Language

PHOENIX VAPERS — BRAND IDENTITY SYSTEM

4

Logo Philosophy & Construction

The mark reclaims the Phoenix from the category's cliché. There is no flame, no smoke, no feather rendered in literal detail – only ascent, expressed as pure geometry.

The vaping category has reduced the Phoenix to a bonfire. This identity restores it to its meaning: renewal, rising, the disciplined ascent of something better. The mark is built from three chevrons of increasing lift, released by a single apex breaking free above them. It reads at once as upward motion, as a stylised wing, and as the peak of a rising form. It is drawn on a strict geometric grid so that it feels engineered rather than illustrated — the visual equivalent of the brand's central claim.



FIG. 16.1 — PRIMARY HORIZONTAL LOCKUP. MARK AND WORDMARK IN FIXED RELATIONSHIP.

The system of marks

The identity is a family, not a single asset. The **primary lockup** (mark plus wordmark) is the default for most applications. The **stacked lockup** serves square and vertical formats. The **mark alone** operates where the brand is already established — app icons, embossing, small merchandise, the debossed base of a bottle. The **wordmark alone** serves running text and legal contexts. Each is a considered response to a real constraint, never an arbitrary variation.



FIG. 16.2 – STACKED LOCKUP



FIG. 16.3 – REVERSED, ON INK GREEN

Construction geometry

The mark is constructed on a unit grid where one unit (1u) equals the stroke width. Every angle is a multiple of fifteen degrees; every terminal is a true radius. The chevrons ascend on a consistent interval, and the apex sits at a fixed remove above the uppermost chevron. Nothing in the mark is drawn by eye. This is the point: an engineering-led brand must have an engineered mark, reproducible from specification alone.

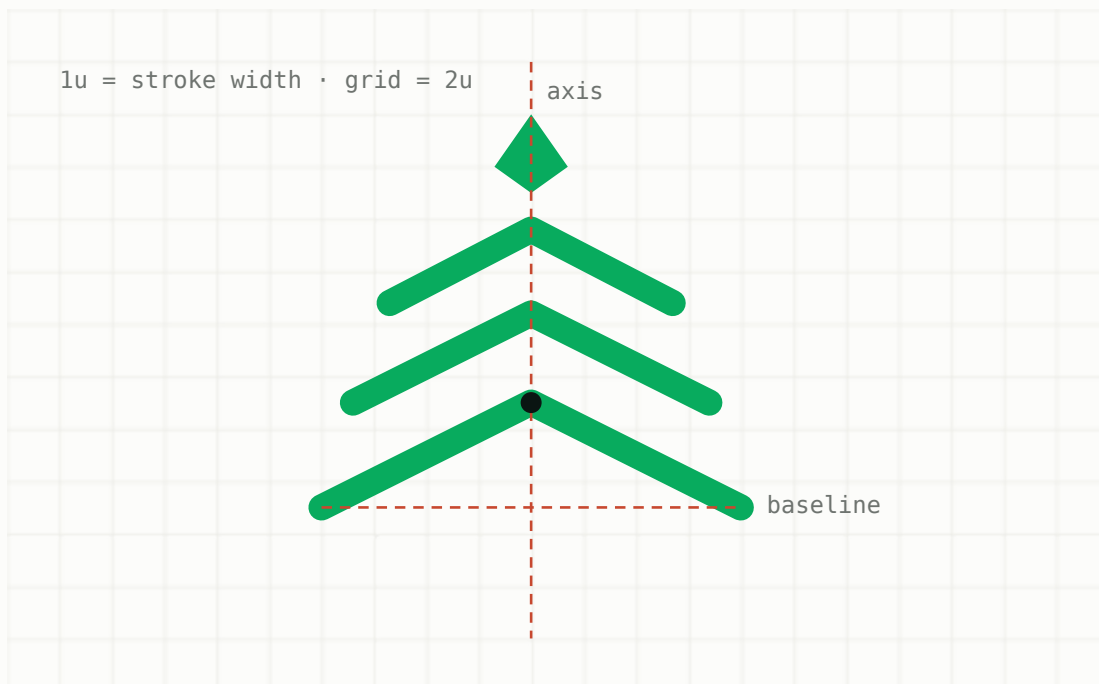


FIG. 16.4 – MARK CONSTRUCTION ON THE UNIT GRID. REPRODUCE FROM THESE RELATIONSHIPS, NEVER REDRAW FREEHAND.

ABSOLUTE RULE

The mark is never redrawn, re-proportioned, or reconstructed. Only the master artwork files are used. If the geometry appears wrong at any size, the fault is in the reproduction, not the mark.

Clear Space, Sizing & Misuse

A mark is only as strong as the space around it and the discipline applied to it. These rules protect the identity from the thousand small compromises that erode a brand over a decade.

Clear space

The logo is given room to breathe. The minimum exclusion zone on all sides equals the height of the apex element (defined as x). No text, image, rule, or competing element may enter this zone. More space is always acceptable; less is never. Clear space is what allows the mark to register as a mark rather than as one more item in a crowded field — and in a category defined by clutter, that separation is itself a brand signal.



FIG. 17.1 — CLEAR SPACE EQUALS x ON EVERY SIDE, WHERE x IS THE APEX HEIGHT.

Minimum sizes

Below a threshold, the mark's geometry degrades and legibility fails. These minimums are absolute. Where space forces a smaller footprint, the mark-only version is used rather than a shrunken lockup.

APPLICATION	PRIMARY LOCKUP	MARK ONLY
Print	28mm wide minimum	8mm wide minimum
Screen	150px wide minimum	32px wide minimum
Embossing / deboss	Not used	10mm minimum

Misuse

The following are prohibited without exception. Each corresponds to a real temptation and each undermines the engineered discipline the mark exists to convey.

× 01

Do not recolour

The mark appears only in Phoenix Green, Ink Green, Bone, or single-colour black. Never in unapproved colours or gradients.

× 02

Do not distort

Never stretch, compress, skew, or rotate. The proportions are fixed by construction.

× 03

Do not add effects

No shadows, glows, bevels, outlines, or — above all — flames. The mark is flat, always.

× 04

Do not rearrange

Mark and wordmark keep their fixed relationship. Never resize one relative to the other.

× 05

Do not crowd

Never place inside the clear space, on a busy image, or on a low-contrast field.

× 06

Do not reconstruct

Never rebuild from memory or substitute a similar typeface. Use master artwork only.

The Colour System

The brand green is the inheritance and the anchor. It is not replaced. It is disciplined — given a supporting cast of depth greens, a serious neutral spine, and a strictly ring-fenced set of functional signals.

Colour is the fastest brand signal the mind processes — recognised before form, before word. The existing Phoenix green, **#08AB5E**, already carries equity and must be retained. Its role, however, changes. In the current identity it does much of the work alone; in this system it becomes a precise instrument used with restraint, set against a sophisticated neutral palette that supplies the premium, engineered gravity the brand needs. Green becomes the accent of confidence, not the volume of the whole page. Used sparingly against Bone and Ink, it reads as considered; used everywhere, it reads as a discount sticker. Restraint is the entire discipline of this chapter.

Colour psychology

Green is the most trust-adjacent hue available to the brand. It signals safety, growth, health, and the natural — associations of unusual value to a company arguing that a regulated product can be made responsibly. This particular green sits in the emerald-to-jade region: vivid enough to feel modern and technological, deep enough to avoid the childish brightness of the disposable palette. Paired with a near-black Ink Green and a warm Bone, it acquires the quality the brand needs above all: it looks *engineered*, not sweet.

The core palette



#08AB5E

Phoenix Green
Primary · the brand signal

RGB	8 · 171 · 94
CMYK	95 · 0 · 45 · 33
PANTONE	354 C / 2423 C*



#05633A

Deep Pine
Green text on light · depth

RGB	5 · 99 · 58
CMYK	95 · 0 · 41 · 61
PANTONE	348 C / 349 C*

#073B25 Forest Ink Dividers · rich backgrounds RGB 7 · 59 · 37 CMYK 88 · 0 · 37 · 77 PANTONE 3435 C*	#0A1512 Ink Green Primary dark · covers · text RGB 10 · 21 · 18 CMYK 52 · 0 · 14 · 92 PANTONE Black 6 C*
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The neutral spine

Neutrals carry the premium weight. The palette runs from a warm off-white through greys to graphite — deliberately warm rather than clinical, so the brand reads as considered and human rather than sterile. Bone is the default background of the brand: paper, screen, and packaging alike.

Bone	Mist	Ash	Slate	Steel	Graphite
F7F6F2	E9E9E3	C7C9C4	6E736F	3A3F3C	14181A

Functional signals

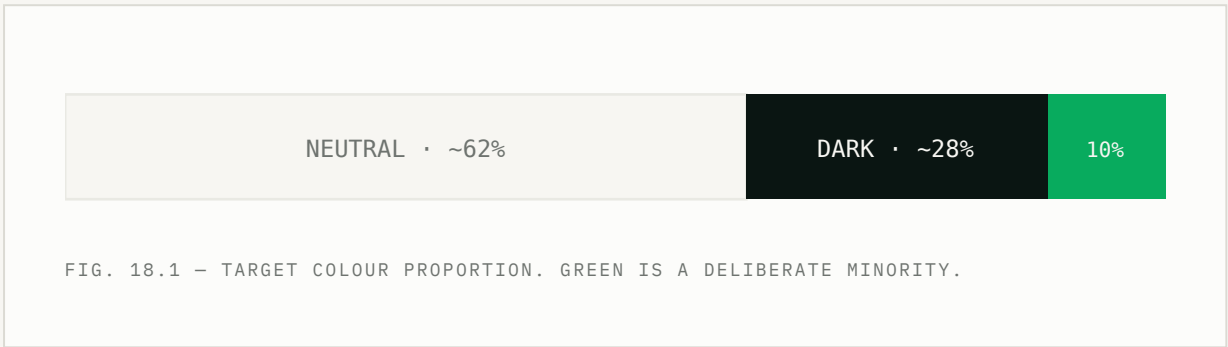
A compliance-first product needs honest interface states — caution, information, error. These colours are **strictly functional**: reserved for the digital product and safety-critical labelling, never used as brand or decorative colour. Segregating semantic colour from brand colour is standard practice in disciplined systems and prevents the palette from drifting into noise.

#E8A33D Caution Amber Warnings only	#3E7CA8 Signal Blue Information only	#C7482F Alert Errors only
---	--	---

* Pantone references are nearest-match recommendations and must be confirmed against current physical colour standards (coated and uncoated) before production. Screen and print will not match without proofing; always sign off to a physical proof, not a monitor.

Proportion & application

The single most important colour rule is proportion. Across any surface, the palette should resolve to roughly the ratio below — a dominant neutral field, a substantial dark, and green as a minority accent. This proportion is what separates a premium identity from a promotional one.



MEDIUM	GREEN USAGE	GUIDANCE
Digital	#08AB5E for actions, focus, brand marks	Reserve for primary actions and the mark; never for large fills of text
Print (coated)	Pantone spot preferred over CMYK build	Spot colour holds the green far more reliably than a four-colour build
Packaging	Green foil or spot on Bone or Ink	A single confident green element outperforms multiple
Environmental / signage	Green as accent on dark or neutral	Match to a physical standard; verify under retail lighting
Vehicle	Ink Green body, green mark	Legibility and restraint at distance; avoid full green wraps

Colour Accessibility

Accessibility is not a constraint on the palette. It is a discipline that makes the palette work — and it produces one rule that every designer and developer must internalise.

The brand green is vivid, but vividness and contrast are not the same thing. Measured against the WCAG contrast standard, **#08AB5E on white reaches only 3.0:1** — sufficient for large text and interface components, but below the 4.5:1 required for normal body text. This is not a flaw to hide; it is a specification to design around. The system resolves it cleanly with a single governing rule.

THE GOVERNING ACCESSIBILITY RULE

Never set body text in Phoenix Green on a light background. For green text on light, use (7.36:1 — passes AAA). Reserve Phoenix Green for fills, large display type, interface accents, and use on dark backgrounds, where it reaches 6.2:1 on Ink Green.

FOREGROUND	BACKGROUND	RATIO	VERDICT
Phoenix Green #08AB5E	White	3.0:1	Large / UI only
Phoenix Green #08AB5E	Ink Green #0A1512	6.2:1	Passes AA
Deep Pine #05633A	White	7.36:1	Passes AAA
Graphite #14181A	Bone #F7F6F2	16.5:1	Passes AAA
Slate #6E736F	Bone #F7F6F2	4.47:1	Body-text minimum
Bone #F7F6F2	Ink Green #0A1512	18.6:1	Passes AAA

Beyond contrast

Colour is never the sole carrier of meaning. Interface states pair colour with an icon and a label so that colour-blind users are never excluded — an error is red *and* marked *and* written. Green and its functional counterparts are chosen to remain distinguishable across the common forms of colour vision deficiency, and every critical combination is verified in build, not assumed. Accessibility, like compliance, is treated as evidence of the brand's respect for the person on the other side of the screen.

Typography

Three typefaces, three jobs. A neutral grotesque for clarity, an editorial serif for authority, and a technical mono for evidence. Together they let the brand sound engineered, trustworthy, and precise in the same breath.

Type does more of the brand's work than any other element, because most brand encounters are acts of reading. The system is deliberately tripartite, and each face is chosen for what it signals as much as for how it performs. The combination is the point: clarity, authority, and precision are exactly the three registers a compliance-first, engineering-led brand must command.

PRIMARY ·
GROTESQUE

Phoenix Sans

A neutral, highly legible grotesque with a large x-height and open apertures — the typeface of engineering-led brands. It is the workhorse: user interface, packaging data, body copy, signage, forms. Its neutrality is its virtue; it never editorialises. Recommended cut: **Inter**, with **Inter Tight** for large display. Both are variable, screen-optimised, and openly licensed for unlimited commercial use — a practical asset for an advertising-restricted brand that lives on its own owned surfaces.

EDITORIAL · SERIF

Phoenix Editorial

A refined, contemporary serif with optical sizing, used sparingly for moments of authority and storytelling: chapter openers, brand statements, premium print, considered editorial. It supplies the heritage and gravity a pure sans cannot, and its restraint keeps the brand from ever feeling clinical. Recommended cut: **Newsreader**. Used only where a moment deserves weight — never for interface or data.

TECHNICAL · MONO

Phoenix Mono

A monospace face for the language of evidence: batch codes, ingredient panels, specifications, lab values, kickers, and technical annotation. It makes the brand's rigour visible — the typographic signature of a company that tests what it makes. Recommended cut: **IBM Plex Mono**. Used in small, deliberate quantities as a mark of precision, never as body text.

Aa Bb Gg Rr 0123456789 & £ % /

Type hierarchy & scale

A hierarchy exists to make importance instantly legible without the reader thinking about it. The system uses a restrained modular scale and heavy reliance on weight and space rather than colour or ornament to signal level. Whitespace is a structural element, not leftover room; the brand's premium quality is carried as much by what surrounds the type as by the type itself.

LEVEL	FACE / WEIGHT	USE
Display	Phoenix Display 800, tight tracking	Covers, hero statements, campaign headlines
Heading	Phoenix Display 700	Chapter and section titles
Subhead	Phoenix Sans 600	In-content structure
Lead	Phoenix Editorial 300, generous leading	Standfirsts, opening statements
Body	Phoenix Sans 400, 1.6 line height	Running text
Caption / kicker	Phoenix Mono 500, wide tracking, uppercase	Labels, metadata, technical notes

Setting 01

Left-aligned, ragged right

The brand sets ragged right for a human, unforced rhythm. Justified text is avoided; its rivers read as rigid rather than refined.

Setting 02

Generous leading, tight display

Body leads open for calm; display tracks tight for confidence. The contrast between the two is a signature of the system.

FALLBACK STACK

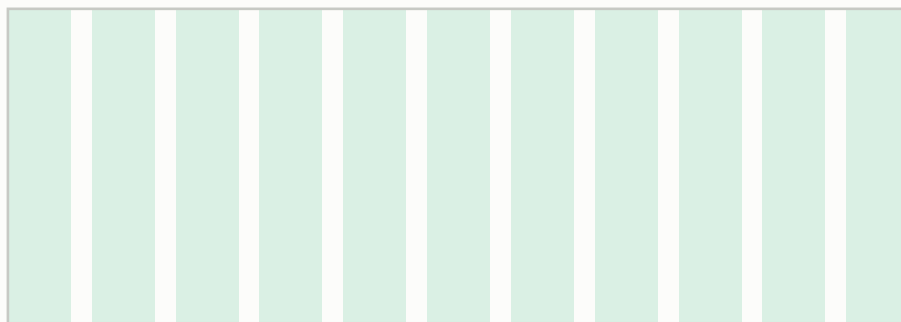
Where brand fonts cannot load — email clients, third-party platforms — the approved fallback is a system grotesque (Helvetica Neue, Arial) for sans and Georgia for serif. Consistency of hierarchy matters more than fidelity of face in these constrained contexts.

Grid, Layout & Iconography

Structure is invisible when it works and unmistakable when it fails. The grid is the silent proof that the same engineering discipline behind the product governs its communication.

The layout grid

All brand layouts derive from a twelve-column grid with a consistent gutter and a baseline rhythm. Twelve divides cleanly into halves, thirds, quarters, and sixths, giving flexibility without improvisation. Generous outer margins frame content and signal premium confidence — the brand is comfortable leaving space empty. Alignment is strict: elements share edges and baselines, and nothing floats. The grid is never shown to the customer, but its order is always felt.



12 columns · consistent gutter · strict baseline

FIG. 21.1 — THE TWELVE-COLUMN EDITORIAL GRID UNDERLYING ALL BRAND LAYOUTS.

Iconography

Icons are drawn as a single family: geometric, line-based, with a consistent stroke weight matched to the mark, rounded terminals, and no fill. They are functional pictograms, not illustrations — legible at small sizes and calm in aggregate. The style deliberately echoes the mark's construction so that an icon and the logo feel made by the same hand. Icons never carry colour beyond the system; they are graphite on light, bone on dark, green only when active.



MOTION, BRIEFLY

Where the brand moves — interface, screens, digital — motion is calm, brief, and eased. Transitions are short (150–250ms), functional, and never bouncy or playful. The brand rises; it does not jump. Movement should feel like precision engineering settling into place.

Photography & Graphic Language

The brand is photographed the way a precision instrument is photographed — with light, control, and respect for the object. No lifestyle clichés, no clouds of vapour, no smoke.

Art direction

Photography is the fastest way to betray a premium position, and the vaping category betrays it constantly — neon-lit clouds, party imagery, product shots that look like packaging for sweets. Phoenix Vapers photographs in an entirely different register. Products are shown as designed objects: clean surfaces, controlled directional light, honest materials, deep shadow, generous negative space. The reference points are the product photography of premium technology and design brands, not the vaping industry. Vapour, when it must appear, is a faint, controlled trace — never a spectacle.

Photo 01

Object as hero

The product, sharply resolved, against a restrained field of Bone or Ink. The engineering is the subject; nothing distracts from it.

Photo 02

Controlled light

Single directional source, real shadow, no flat over-lighting. Light models the form and signals seriousness.

Photo 03

Detail & material

Macro on the real texture of a label, a thread, a machined edge. Proof of craft, shown not claimed.

Photo 04

People, rarely & real

When people appear, they are unmistakably adult, calm, and unstyled — never a party, never youth-coded.

Image treatment

A consistent treatment unifies imagery from many sources: slightly desaturated, neutral-to-cool grade, protected shadows, no heavy filters. A single duotone in Ink Green and Bone is available for editorial and campaign use where a unifying wash is wanted. Green is introduced into imagery only through the real product or a graphic element laid over the photograph — never through a colour cast.

Beyond the logo, the brand owns one proprietary graphic device: **The Ascent** — the chevron rhythm of the mark abstracted into a structural motif. It appears as a subtle ascending line, a corner detail, a section marker, or a large architectural element cropped off-page. It is always geometric, always calm, always derived from the mark's angles. It gives the system a recognisable signature that works even where the full logo does not appear.

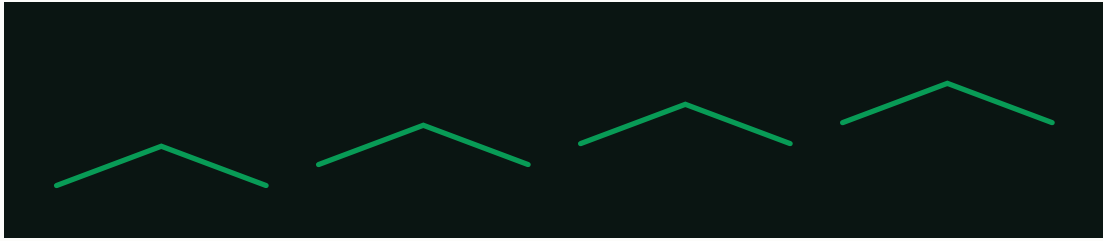


FIG. 22.1 — THE ASCENT MOTIF: THE MARK'S GEOMETRY EXTENDED AS A SIGNATURE GRAPHIC.

PATTERNS & TEXTURE

Where a pattern is needed, it is built from The Ascent at low contrast — never a busy repeat. Texture is drawn from real materials: uncoated paper, matte polymer, machined metal. The brand's surfaces should feel good in the hand, because tactility is a premium signal that photographs cannot fake.

ON RESTRAINT

In a category that spent a decade shouting,
the most radical thing a brand can do is
speak quietly, and mean it.

PHOENIX VAPERS · BRAND PHILOSOPHY

PART FIVE

Application

- 23 Packaging System
- 24 Retail, Environment & Fleet
- 25 Digital Product & Design Tokens
- 26 Stationery & Merchandise

5

Packaging System

Packaging is the brand's most important medium. In an advertising-restricted market it is where the sale is made, the trust is signalled, and the standard is proven — held in the customer's hand.

A vape bottle sits on a shelf beside dozens of competitors, most of them loud. Phoenix Vapers wins that shelf not by shouting louder but by looking unmistakably more serious — the one adult object in a display of noise. The packaging philosophy is disciplined minimalism: a restrained field, one confident green element, precise typographic information, and honest materials. The mandatory regulatory content is designed *in*, treated as evidence of care rather than as clutter to minimise.

Packaging principles

Pack 01

One green moment

A single confident use of green — a foil mark, a spot band — against Bone or Ink. Restraint reads as premium; multiplicity reads as promotion.

Pack 02

Information as design

Strength, ratio, volume, batch, and warnings set in the type system with clarity and hierarchy. Nothing hidden, nothing shrunk.

Pack 03

Honest materials

Uncoated or soft-touch stocks, recyclable mono-materials, minimal finishing. The pack should feel considered in the hand.

Pack 04

System, not one-offs

Ranges share a template and vary only by a disciplined colour or name field, so a shelf of Phoenix products reads as one family.



FIG. 23.1 — 10ML TPD LABEL



FIG. 23.2 — SHORTFILL, INK VARIANT

Across the packaging chain

FORMAT	TREATMENT
Bottle labels	Single template; variant differentiated by name field and strength; regulatory panel designed-in
Cartons	Bone or Ink; debossed mark; matte finish; batch and notification data in mono
Gift boxes	Rigid board, soft-touch, green foil mark; minimal, tactile, considered unboxing
Shipping boxes	Unbleached board, single-colour mark, printed responsibly; discreet, not a billboard
Wholesale	Functional, clearly labelled, compliance-forward; the standard visible to trade partners

Retail, Environment & Fleet

The physical brand — stores, point of sale, exhibitions, vehicles, and staff — is where trust is either confirmed or contradicted in person.

Retail environment

The store is a three-dimensional argument for the brand. It should feel closer to a considered technology or apothecary retail space than to a conventional vape shop: calm lighting, clear sightlines, generous space around product, materials that match the packaging. Age verification is visible and matter-of-fact — a sign of care, not suspicion. The EL-Science risk assessments, available in store, are presented as a genuine point of pride rather than hidden in a folder. Everything the customer touches confirms the promise made on the label.

Retail 01

Fascia & signage

Ink Green fascia, green mark, restrained. Environmental graphics use The Ascent. Legible at distance; never cluttered with offers.

Retail 02

Point of sale & display

Modular units in system materials; products displayed as objects with clear specification cards in the type system. Order over abundance.

Retail 03

Exhibition & wholesale stand

A calm, architectural stand that stands out precisely by refusing the trade-show noise around it. The Ascent at architectural scale.

Retail 04

Click & collect

The bridge between digital and physical: branded, efficient, respectful of time. The handover is a brand moment, handled with care.

Fleet & uniform

Vehicles are Ink Green with a single green mark and minimal wording — a moving proof of a serious operation, not a mobile advertisement (which regulation increasingly restricts in any case). Uniform is simple and dignified: dark workwear or apron in system colours, a discreet embroidered mark, quality fabric. Staff should look like specialists, because they are. The person behind the counter is the final, human expression of the brand, and they are dressed to be trusted.



FIG. 24.1 – FLEET LIVERY. RESTRAINT AT SPEED AND DISTANCE.

Digital Product & Design Tokens

The website and future platform are not brochures. They are the brand as software — and in a licensed, verified, data-driven market, the digital product is where the company's technological future is built.

The e-commerce platform is the brand's largest owned surface and the foundation of its ambition to become a technology platform. It must feel as engineered as the products it sells: fast, clear, calm, and trustworthy. Age and identity verification are designed as reassuring, competent moments rather than friction. Product pages lead with specification and evidence. The interface uses the type system, the neutral spine, and green reserved for action and confirmation. Nothing on the screen should feel improvised.

Interface principles

UI 01

Evidence-forward

Specification, provenance, and risk-assessment access are primary content, not buried tabs. The proof leads.

UI 02

Calm & fast

Restrained motion, generous space, immediate response. Speed and stillness both read as competence.

UI 03

Verification as care

Age checks framed as responsibility, not obstacle. Clear, quick, respectful of the adult on the other side.

UI 04

Accessible by default

WCAG AA minimum; the Deep Pine rule enforced in code; never colour alone for meaning.

Design tokens

The visual system is expressed to engineering as tokens — named, versioned variables that keep design and code in perfect agreement. Tokens are the mechanism by which brand governance survives contact with a real codebase. The core set:

TOKEN	VALUE	ROLE
color.brand.primary	#08AB5E	Actions, focus, brand accent
color.brand.text-green	#05633A	Green text on light (accessible)
color.ink	#0A1512	Primary dark surface / text
color.surface	#F7F6F2	Default background
color.text.secondary	#6E736F	Secondary text
color.state.caution	#E8A33D	Warning state
color.state.error	#C7482F	Error state
font.sans	Inter	UI & body
font.mono	IBM Plex Mono	Data & specification
radius.base	6px	Corner radius
motion.base	200ms ease-out	Default transition
space.unit	8px	Spacing base

SINGLE SOURCE OF TRUTH

Tokens are versioned alongside this book. A change to the palette or type is a change to the tokens, published once and inherited everywhere. This is how an engineering-led brand keeps its identity engineered rather than eroded.

Stationery & Merchandise

The small, everyday artefacts — a business card, an invoice, a delivery note, a tote — are where a brand is either whole or careless. Consistency here is the proof of discipline everywhere.

Corporate stationery

Business cards, letterhead, invoices, compliment slips, and email signatures share one restrained system: Bone stock, generous margins, the mark, the type system, and information set with the same clarity as a product label. Trade and wholesale documentation carries the compliance-forward tone of the brand — a Phoenix Vapers invoice should feel as considered as a Phoenix Vapers bottle. Cards are printed on heavy uncoated stock, ideally with a debossed mark: the brand is felt before it is read.

Doc 01

Letterhead & invoices

Bone, 12-column grid, mark top-left, mono for reference data. Legal footer set legibly. Quiet authority on paper.

Doc 02

Delivery & packing notes

Part of the unboxing; a considered note, not a receipt. Confirms provenance and thanks the customer without hype.

Merchandise

Merchandise is produced sparingly and only to a premium standard — the brand would rather make nothing than make something cheap. Where it exists, it favours function and quality: a well-made tote in natural canvas, an enamel pin of the mark, a durable travel case for hardware. Every item must pass one test: would an adult who values good things actually keep it? If not, it is not made. Cheap promotional merchandise contradicts the entire position and is prohibited.

THE CONSISTENCY TEST

Lay every artefact the company produces side by side — bottle, card, invoice, box, screen, tote. They must look like one company made all of them, to one standard. Where an item breaks the family, the item is wrong, not the system.

PART SIX

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Sustainability & Responsibility

The disposable ban was, at root, an environmental judgement on the category. A brand claiming responsibility must answer that judgement in substance, not slogan.

Millions of single-use vapes were discarded every week before the 2025 ban — lithium batteries and plastic in landfill and on pavements. That waste is the moral backdrop against which every vaping brand is now read. Phoenix Vapers' commitment to reusable, refillable formats is not merely commercial alignment with the law; it is the practical expression of its responsibility value. Sustainability, for this brand, is a design and operations discipline, and it is stated only where it is true.

Commitments in substance

Env 01

Reusable by design

The range favours refillable and pod systems that keep devices in use and out of landfill. Longevity is designed in, not sold against.

Env 02

Honest packaging

Recyclable mono-materials, reduced finishing, right-sized boxes. Restraint is also a material saving.

Env 03

Take-back & recycling

Battery and device recycling offered in store — closing the loop the disposable era left open.

Env 04

No greenwashing

Environmental claims are specific, measurable, and evidenced. The brand says less than it does, never more.

THE RULE ON CLAIMS

The brand never uses sustainability as decoration. A green colour is not an environmental claim. Every stated commitment is backed by a real practice the company can show — consistent with the transparency that defines everything else it does.

Social responsibility

Responsibility extends to who the brand reaches. Phoenix Vapers designs, names, and communicates in ways that are unmistakably adult and never appeal to minors — a discipline that also anticipates the packaging and advertising powers of the Tobacco and Vapes Act. Age

verification is rigorous and visible. The brand supports the legitimate public-health role of vaping as a smoking-cessation tool without ever overclaiming it. This is not compliance for its own sake; it is the brand's values made operational.

Governance & Evolution

A brand system is only as strong as its enforcement. This chapter defines how the identity is protected, who protects it, and how it is permitted to change without losing itself.

Ownership & approval

The brand requires a single accountable owner — a brand guardian or custodian — with the authority to approve or reject any application of the identity. Consistency is not achieved by good intentions distributed across many hands; it is achieved by clear ownership and a defined approval path. External partners work from this book and from the master asset library, and their output is signed off against both before release.

ARTEFACT	APPROVAL
New packaging or product identity	Brand guardian + compliance sign-off
Campaign or environmental graphics	Brand guardian
Digital product changes to tokens	Brand guardian + engineering
Routine collateral on template	Delegated, within system rules
Any use of the logo by a third party	Brand guardian, in writing

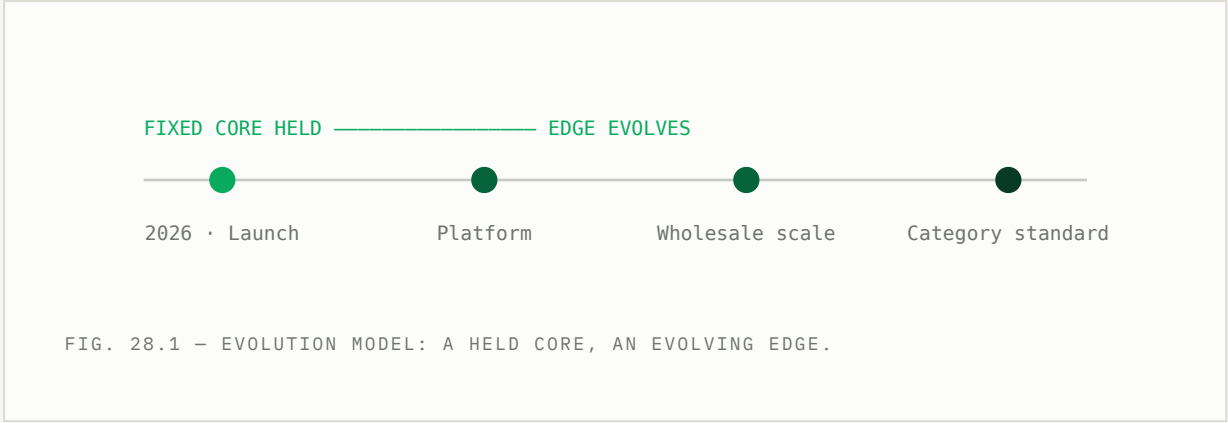
Asset management

Master artwork — logos, fonts, tokens, templates, this document — lives in a single, versioned, access-controlled library. No one recreates an asset that already exists; no one works from a file pulled off a website or a colleague's desktop. Each asset is versioned, and the current version is the only permitted one. This is the operational backbone of consistency, and it is treated with the same rigour as the product's own quality management.

Evolution roadmap

A brand must be stable to be trusted and alive to stay relevant. Phoenix Vapers resolves this tension by distinguishing the **fixed core** — position, values, mark, green, type system — from the **flexible edge** — campaigns, photography, seasonal expression, new applications. The core changes rarely and only through formal review; the edge evolves continuously within the system. The likely evolution over the coming decade tracks the market: deeper investment in the digital and data platform as licensing matures, extension of the standard through wholesale, and readiness for whatever secondary legislation the Tobacco and Vapes Act brings. The brand is

built to absorb that change without a rebrand — which is precisely the point of building it properly now.



Executive Statement

Everything in this book reduces to one idea, and the idea is worth stating plainly at the end, as it was at the beginning.

The United Kingdom vaping market has been forced to grow up. The disposable culture is illegal, advertising is being switched off, duty is flattening the price game, and licensing is rewarding the credentialled. In that corrected market, the winners will not be the loudest or the cheapest. They will be the most trusted. Phoenix Vapers is built — genuinely, in its manufacturing, its testing, its certification, and its conduct — to be exactly that. The work of this brand system has been to make an existing truth visible, premium, and impossible to confuse with the noise the country has left behind.

The identity is restrained because the position demands restraint. The green is retained because equity is not discarded lightly. The typography is engineered because the brand is engineered. The voice is calm because trust is calm. The packaging is quiet because quiet, in this category, is the loudest possible signal of confidence. None of it is decoration. All of it is strategy, expressed as design.

Held to consistently, protected properly, and evolved with discipline, this system will not need replacing. It will compound — growing more recognisable, more valuable, and more trusted with every year it is applied without compromise. That is the definition of a brand asset, and it is what this book is built to create.

THE WHOLE BOOK IN ONE LINE

**A disposable brand sells a moment. Phoenix Vapers sells a standard.
Everything here exists to make that standard visible — and to hold it.**



The standard of trust in British vaping.

PHOENIX VAPERS LIMITED · PETERBOROUGH · UNITED KINGDOM
BRAND IDENTITY SYSTEM · VOLUME ONE · EDITION 1.0 · CONFIDENTIAL